

Chosen from a Shortlist: Kure and Its Naval Century

In 1883 the navy's surveyors quietly measured a fishing bay against three rival sites. Once Kure won, the navy took half of one village's land, built the port that launched the battleship Yamato, and for a time after 1945 commanded occupying Australian and British forces from here. This dossier reads the fishing village underneath the fleet base.



呉（呉市中央）

In this dossier

1. A history of the district (7 chapters, about 1800 words)
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Written in English from Japanese library sources — chiefly books digitised by the National Diet Library — and official records. Superscript numbers point to the numbered sources at the end, with page frames for the digitised books.

Chosen from a shortlist

Before the navy came, Kure was a small farming and fishing settlement on Aki Bay, one of several villages the Meiji navy quietly compared against each other. In February 1883 the Navy Hydrographic Department sent Lieutenant Commander Kimotsuki and Lieutenant Miura to survey Kure Bay and the waters nearby; Tokuyama, Mihara and the island of Etajima were also candidates for what would become the navy's Second District headquarters. A district history published in 1943 recalls that rumors of the survey alone unsettled a village that, as yet, knew nothing of the navy. On 14 July 1884 Prince Arisugawa Takehito, with the navy minister and other senior officers, came in person to inspect Kure Bay and its shore; once the survey confirmed it as the best of the candidates, orders went out to begin buying land.¹

The following year the choice was sealed in public. On 4 August 1885, during a tour of Yamaguchi and Hiroshima prefectures, Emperor Meiji sailed into Kure Bay escorted by the warship Kasuga, walked the deck to view the future naval port's site for himself, and was told in detail why it had been chosen; villagers who lined the shore, the same history records, wept at the sight of the imperial ship passing far out on the water.¹

Buying the land took several rounds of negotiation between 1884 and 1888, led in turn by a changing cast of naval officers. It fell hardest on Miyahara, the village whose fields and house lots covered the ground the new town would actually occupy: the navy eventually took half of Miyahara's roughly 153 cho of farmland and residential land, and the 1943 history says plainly that the village saw a change 'nearly amounting to its total destruction.' The neighboring villages of Washo and Shoyamada lost every part of their land that faced the sea, though Washo kept some houses and Shoyamada, being newer reclaimed ground, had only a handful of households to move. The same source records the compensation paid per unit of land: at most a little over 170 yen for the best paddy fields, as little as 50 yen for poor dry fields, and up to 200 yen for house plots, figures that meant something very different to a farming household than to the navy drawing up its budget.¹

Before the port existed, official visitors simply lodged with local people. The 1943 history notes that Kimotsuki, the officer who surveyed the bay in 1883, and Maki, who came to arrange land purchases in 1885, both stayed at a commoner's house near the bay called the Ebisuya; later dignitaries, including the future prime minister Ito Hirobumi and the navy minister who attended the port's opening ceremony, lodged at a private house in Wada village for lack of anything grander. The first sailors transferred from Yokosuka in 1889 landed from a merchant ship at Kwarishi and were put up at an inn called the Akamatsuya, a measure of how little of a naval town existed yet even as the chinjufu itself opened for business.¹

Chinjufu and city

The paperwork that mattered most was signed on 28 May 1889, when a naval ordinance formally placed the Second Naval District's chinjufu, or naval district headquarters, at Kure, alongside Yokosuka and Sasebo. Its first commander, Nakamuta, sailed in and took up his post on 22 June that year; because the old chinjufu system was being reorganized at the same moment, his arrival ceremony was combined with the base's own opening. Two sources consulted for this dossier, one from 1935 and one from 1943, both date the chinjufu's formal opening ceremony to the following year, 1890, suggesting the base was already at work for months before it was ceremonially declared open.¹²

What followed was explosive growth. Kure counted around 39,600 people in 1898; by the time it was incorporated as a city on 1 October 1902, under its first mayor, Sakuma Giichiro, it had 13,809 households and 60,132 residents, and its own household registers for that year show more people living there as temporary migrants than as locally registered residents. The merger that created the city was itself pushed through in a single afternoon: the prefectural governor sailed to Kure on 26 January 1902, met some sixty local representatives at Myohoji temple, and argued that a naval arsenal town competing for a planned national steelworks could not afford four separate village administrations for its water, schools, roads and fire brigades.¹

A garrison town takes shape

The years around the chinjufu's opening turned a construction site into a town in a hurry. A telegraph line to Hiroshima was under construction by 1886 and running by the next year; a straight new road ran from the naval gate through Washo, with further roads pushed out to Yoshiura, Aga, Hiro, Miyahara and Kego-ya; steamers began calling at Kwarishi; the Aki district government office moved to Kure from Kaita in April 1887; and elementary schools, a red-light district at Yoshiura and a bathing resort all opened within a few years of each other. The military and civilian sides of the new town marked their new relationship in person: on New Year's Day 1888 some 120 people, naval officers down to the chinjufu's chief surgeon and paymaster, county officials and the heads of the three villages, gathered for the first joint New Year's party at a restaurant in Wada village, an occasion the 1943 history calls the start of official-and-civilian goodwill in the port town.¹

War, when it came, brought the imperial family to Kure in person. During the war with China, Emperor Meiji sailed into the naval port on 2 October 1894, lunched at the chinjufu, inspected the warships Hiei and Saikyo-maru, handed out sake to their crews and sent an envoy to console the wounded at the naval hospital; the crown prince followed on 19 November, watching net-fishing near the coal depot before his own hospital visit and a tour of the shipyard; the Empress came in her turn on 30 March 1895, going directly from the chinjufu to the naval hospital to see the wounded. The same years saw the port's first full-scale naval exercise, in 1891, fought out across the straits and hills around nearby Nomi Island and Miyajima with a mock headquarters, coastal gun positions and a field hospital, a rehearsal for the war that would follow within the decade.¹

The Orient's greatest naval port

By 1935 a city guidebook could call Kure one of Japan's ten largest cities, with about 230,000 people and, in its own words, the Orient's greatest naval port, able to berth more than sixty warships of the Combined Fleet at once. The Naval Arsenal's own workforce had already lived through one full boom and bust: it passed 30,000 workers at the height of the 'Eight-Eight Fleet' building program in the early 1920s, collapsed almost overnight when the Washington Naval Treaty capped Japan's fleet, and by the mid-1930s was climbing again as international tension returned.²

The Arsenal's best-known product was the battleship Yamato, completed there on 16 December 1941: 263 meters long, 38.9 meters at the beam, with a standard displacement of 65,000 tons, the largest battleship ever built. It survived barely three and a half years of war. Sent out on a one-way mission toward Okinawa with fuel for only a single voyage, Yamato was sunk by American carrier aircraft on 7 April 1945, taking most of her crew down with her.³

War comes home

Kure itself came under direct attack in the war's last year. Library reference sources tracing the city's air-raid record list American attacks on 4 May, 21 June and 1 July 1945, and a further raid on 24 July in which the cruiser Tone, moored in the harbor, came under sustained anti-aircraft fire from around 8:40 in the morning; the wider raids on Hiroshima Prefecture ran from November 1944 to within days of the war's end. Weeks earlier, on 30 March 1945, American B-29s had already sown naval mines across the waters around Kure and Hiroshima as part of a wider campaign to seal the Inland Sea.⁷⁸

The worst single blow, though, fell after the fighting stopped. On 17 September 1945, little more than a month after the surrender, the Makurazaki Typhoon tore through the ruined city: a monument raised afterward records 1,154 dead and 1,162 houses swept away across Kure, with 309 of the dead in Miyahara alone, the same district the navy had half-demolished sixty years before to build the port in the first place. A second flood disaster, in July 1967, killed a further 88 people in the city, 14 of them again in Miyahara, a reminder that the hills hemming in Kure's narrow waterfront make the city as vulnerable to landslides and flash floods as it once was strategically valuable.¹¹

The Commonwealth at Kure

Defeat brought a different kind of occupation. The British Commonwealth Occupation Force (BCOF) — troops from Britain, India, New Zealand and Australia, about 45,000 in all, of whom roughly 16,000 were Australian — landed its main body at Kure on 21 February 1946 and made the former naval port its headquarters, administering Hiroshima, Shimane, Yamaguchi, Tottori and Okayama prefectures and Shikoku on the Allied occupation's behalf. A history of Hiroshima Prefecture's police records that Commonwealth troops based at Kure used an army training ground further inland for exercises from September 1946. The former Imperial Naval Academy on the nearby island of Etajima became the occupying force's general headquarters, its full facilities put to work running the occupation and employing thousands of Japanese laborers; a photograph reproduced in the city's own official history shows some of them building a pumping station for the Commonwealth headquarters there on 26 November 1947, after the base ran short of water.⁹¹⁰¹³

Reading the ground today

The clearest place to take in this whole arc is the Yamato Museum, opened on 23 April 2005 as the city's own maritime history museum, built around a large one-tenth-scale model of the battleship; it drew a million visitors within its first 177 days and had passed fifteen million by 2022. A short walk away, the wooded grounds of the former Kure Naval District commander-in-chief's official residence survive as the Irifuneyama Memorial Hall, now a museum of decorative gilt paper, with the Arsenal's old clock tower still standing on the same grounds.³⁶

The city's own present-day account of itself leads with the same history, describing Kure as a 'Japan Heritage city' before almost anything else. Kure and the three other original chinjufu towns, Yokosuka, Sasebo and Maizuru, are grouped today under a single Japan Heritage designation telling the story of how Meiji Japan built naval defenses at four natural harbors to hold its own against the Western powers, a story whose surviving pieces in Kure include the old headquarters buildings, the shipyard where Yamato was built, and wartime gun emplacements on the surrounding hills. Those same hills, steep and close to the water, are the other half of the story: the district's own disaster memorials, most recently one recording three deaths in a debris flow at Yoshiura in the heavy rains of July 2018, mark a hazard that has run alongside Kure's naval history for its entire century and a half.⁴⁵¹²

Timeline

February 1883	Navy surveyors examine Kure Bay as a candidate site for a new naval district headquarters. ¹
14 July 1884	Prince Arisugawa Takehito personally inspects Kure Bay; land purchases begin soon after. ¹
4 August 1885	Emperor Meiji sails into Kure Bay to view the future naval port's site. ¹
1884-1888	Land is bought from Miyahara, Washo and Shoyamada villages in stages; Miyahara loses about half its farmland and house lots. ¹
28 May 1889	A naval ordinance formally places the Second Naval District's chinjufu at Kure. ¹
22 June 1889	The chinjufu's first commander, Nakamuta, arrives and takes up his post. ¹
1890	Two later sources date the chinjufu's formal opening ceremony to this year. ¹²
1 October 1902	Kure is incorporated as a city, with Sakuma Giichiro as its first mayor; population has already passed 60,000. ¹
16 December 1941	The battleship Yamato is completed at Kure Naval Arsenal. ³
30 March-24 July 1945	American mine-laying and repeated air raids strike Kure, including an attack on the cruiser Tone on 24 July. ^{7 8}
7 April 1945	Yamato is sunk by American carrier aircraft en route to Okinawa. ³
17 September 1945	The Makurazaki Typhoon kills 1,154 people in Kure, 309 of them in Miyahara. ¹¹
21 February 1946	The main body of the British Commonwealth Occupation Force -- troops from Britain, India, New Zealand and Australia -- lands at Kure and makes the former naval port its headquarters. ¹³
23 April 2005	The Yamato Museum opens in Kure. ³

Walking notes

Places to stand and look, in walking order. Straight-line distances only; check today's access and opening before you go.

- 1

Yamato Museum 大和ミュージアム. Kure's own maritime history museum, built around a large-scale model of the battleship Yamato; opened 2005 and now visited by well over a million people a year.³
- 2

Irifuneyama Memorial Hall 入船山記念館. The former official residence of the Kure Naval District's commanders-in-chief, set in wooded grounds that also keep the old Naval Arsenal's clock tower.⁶
- 3

Miyahara 宮原. The village that lost half its land to the naval port in the 1880s and 309 people to the Makurazaki Typhoon in 1945; today part of central Kure, with little visible trace of the farming settlement it once was.¹¹¹
- 4

The Arsenal waterfront 旧海軍工廠地区. The shipyards and dockside where the Yamato and thousands of other naval vessels were built, still in industrial use and best viewed from the Yamato Museum's harbor-facing windows and walkways.²³
- 5

Yoshiura 吉浦. A hillside district on the western edge of the old naval-port land takings, and the site of fatal debris flows in the heavy rains of July 2018, a reminder of the terrain that shaped the port as much as the navy did.¹²

The same ground, 1961–1969 and 2023



1961–1969 aerial photograph — GSI Tiles *ort_old10*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. North is up; the frame is identical in both images.



2023 annual orthophoto — GSI Tiles *nendophoto2023*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. Capture dates within a mosaic can differ from place to place.

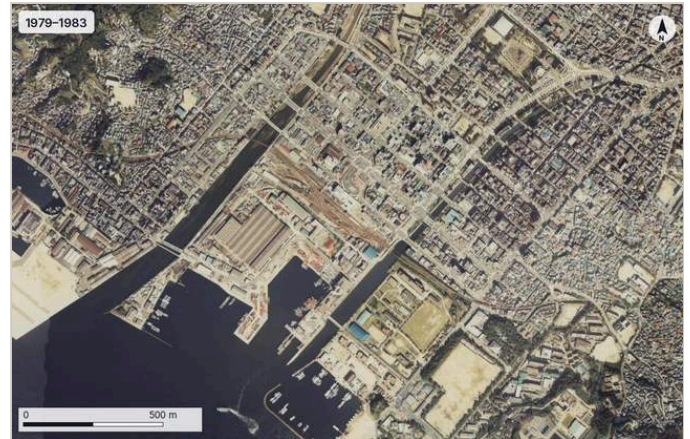
How to compare. Anchor on features that rarely move — river banks, rail lines, shrine and temple grounds, main roads — then look for what changed around them. Differences in tone come from film, camera and season, not from the land itself.

The decades in between

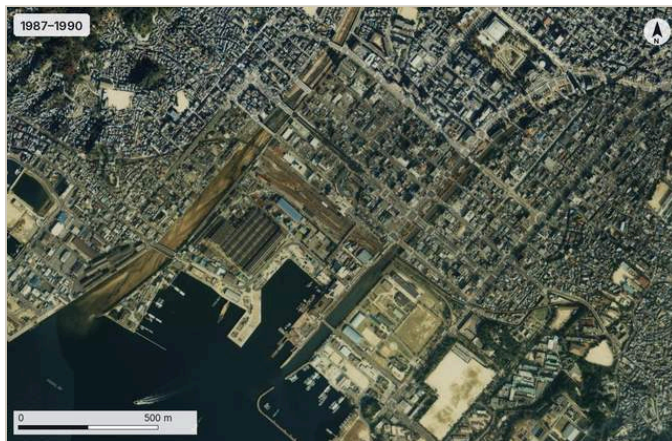
Every further GSI series that covers the same frame, oldest first. Each series is a compilation: photographs within one series were taken on different dates, which is why seams and changes of tone can appear inside a frame.



1974–1978 · GSI Tiles *gazo1*, processed



1979–1983 · GSI Tiles *gazo2*, processed



1987–1990 · GSI Tiles *gazo4*, processed

Rivers, shorelines and terraces



Natural landforms as classified by GSI, over a recent aerial photograph in gray. Dark blue outlines mark former river channels.

■ Floodplain and coastal plain 34%	■ Former water area 20%
■ Mountain and hill slopes 12%	■ Alluvial fan 7.4%
■ Plateaus and terraces 5.0%	■ Water 3.6%
■ Riverbed and beach 0.8%	

What the main landforms mean

Floodplain and coastal plain (34%). Low, flat ground of little relief, built from sand and mud left by floods, or former seabed that emerged. River flooding. Ground is softer nearer the coast and shakes somewhat more; liquefaction tendency is strong on coastal plains and somewhat strong on floodplains. Storm surge near the coast.

Former water area (20%). Land shown by old maps and aerial photographs to have been sea, lake, pond, reservoir or river, later turned into land. Soft ground: very strong liquefaction tendency where filled, strong where drained. Storm surge near the coast.

Mountain and hill slopes (12%). Ridges, valleys and fairly steep ground, including terrace-scarp slopes and volcanic ground. Heavy rain or earthquakes can trigger slope failures, debris flows and landslides.

Alluvial fan (7.4%). Gently sloping ground spreading fan-like from a valley mouth, built from sediment dropped by floods. Floodwater from the mountains, and debris flows near the valley mouth. Relatively firm ground; a slight liquefaction tendency on the lower fan.

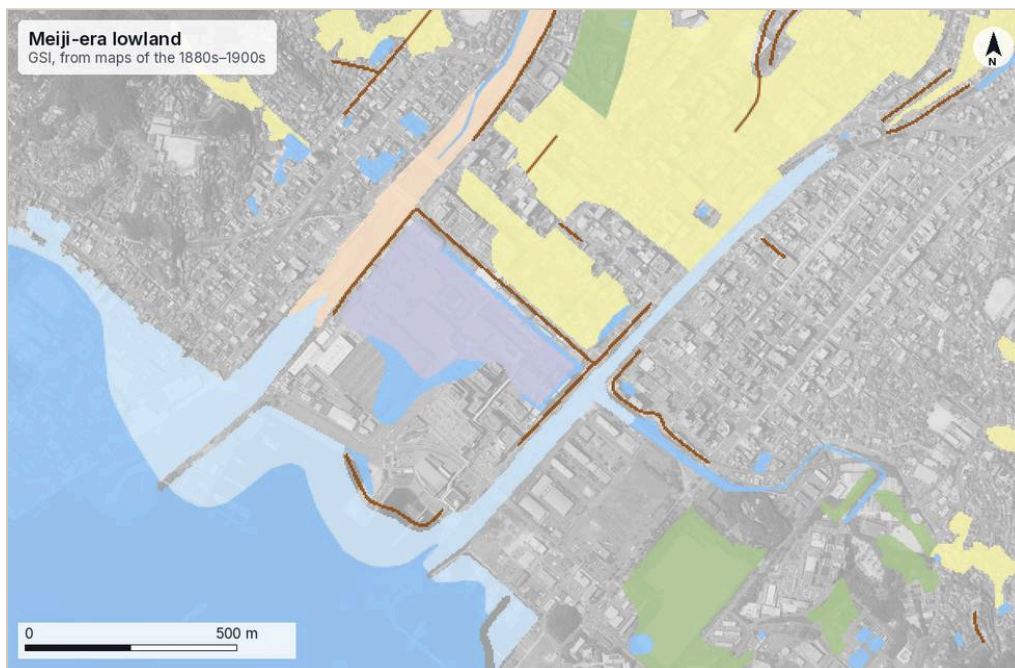
Plateaus and terraces (5.0%). Flat ground standing in steps above its surroundings, left behind as the land around it was eroded. River flooding is rarely a threat unless the terrace is only slightly above the river; watch the slopes at its edges. Firm ground: shaking is relatively weak and liquefaction is unlikely.

Descriptions translated and condensed from GSI's landform-classification legend. They describe tendencies of each landform type, not the condition of any individual plot.

Fill, reclamation and the fields beneath the town



Hatching: man-made ground as classified by GSI. Teal outlines: former sea, river or pond. Dark blue outlines: former river channels.



GSI “Meiji-era lowland” data, traced from topographic maps of the 1880s–1900s; GSI warns that positions can be off by a considerable distance, especially in the Kanto and Kinki regions. Only low, wet or open ground was traced: towns, dry fields and forest of the period are left blank.

Man-made ground

-  Filled and reclaimed land 20%
-  Cut ground 11%

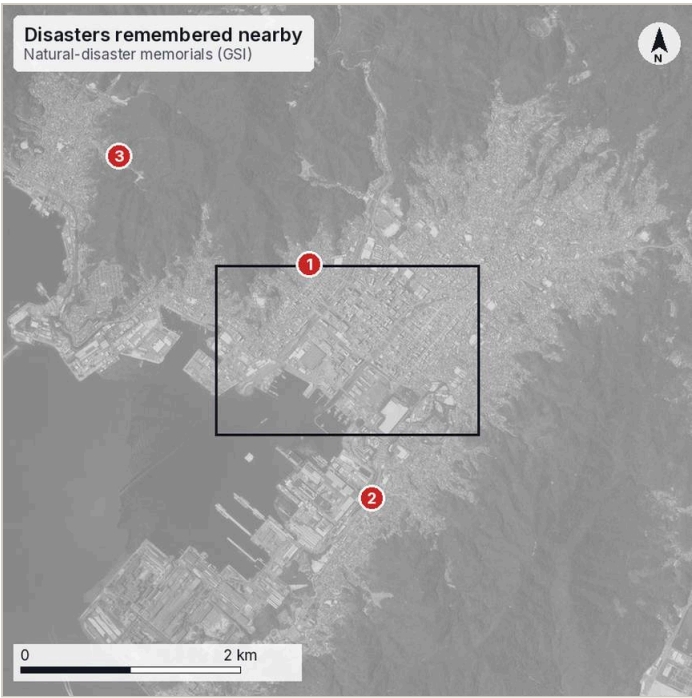
Meiji-era lowland

-  River, pond or sea 16%
-  Rice paddy 12%
-  Tidal flat or beach 6.9%
-  Uncultivated land 3.4%
-  Marsh 2.7%
-  Sand and gravel 1.4%

Filled and reclaimed land (20%). Ground raised with fill, land made by dumping soil into the sea, rivers or ponds, or valleys filled in. May flood if not raised enough; on hills, rain or earthquakes can make the fill fail; in lowlands the liquefaction tendency is very strong, especially on filled sea, lake or river beds.

Cut ground (11%). Ground made by cutting into slopes of mountains or terrace edges. Depending on the cut slope, heavy rain or earthquakes may bring it down; the ground itself is generally firm.

Memorials to natural disasters nearby



Numbered memorials; the black rectangle is the study area of this brief. Frame 6 km across.

Memorial	Disaster	Erected	Distance
1 Monument recording the 2001 Geiyo earthquake 芸予地震伝承碑	Geiyo earthquake (24 Mar 2001) · earthquake	unknown	0.9 km
2 Memorial to the Miyahara victims of the 1945 typhoon and 1967 heavy rain 慰霊碑	Makurazaki Typhoon (17 Sep 1945) and heavy rain of July 1967 (9 Jul 1967) · landslide or debris flow	1995	1.4 km
3 Record of the July 2018 heavy-rain disaster: Yoshiura 1 平成30年7月 豪雨災害の記録 吉浦1	Heavy rain of July 2018 (western Japan floods) · flood / landslide or debris flow	2024	2.7 km

What the memorials record

1. **Monument recording the 2001 Geiyo earthquake.** The Geiyo earthquake at 3:27 pm on 24 March 2001 badly damaged Tainomiya Shrine in Nishimitsuta-machi, Kure: its torii gate collapsed, and roof tiles and the stone guardian dogs (komainu) fell.
2. **Memorial to the Miyahara victims of the 1945 typhoon and 1967 heavy rain.** The Makurazaki Typhoon of 17 September 1945 killed 1,154 people in the then city of Kure and swept away 1,162 houses; 309 of the dead were in Miyahara. On 9 July 1967 torrential rain along the rainy-season front caused landslides and floods across the city, killing 88 people in Kure, 14 of them in Miyahara.
3. **Record of the July 2018 heavy-rain disaster: Yoshiura 1.** In the heavy rain of July 2018, debris flows and slope collapses at many points in the Yoshiura district destroyed buildings and cut roads, and 3 people died in this part of Yoshiura.

Source: GSI Natural Disaster Memorials (自然災害伝承碑). English names and notes are Japan Time Atlas translations and summaries of GSI's Japanese descriptions; the memorials' own inscriptions may say more. "Erected" is the year GSI records for the monument.

Sources

1. 呉新興日報社 (Kure Shinko Nippo-sha), 大呉市民史 明治篇 [A history of greater Kure's citizens: the Meiji volume], 1943; NDL frames 18, 47, 76. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1908953/1/18> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: The 1883-85 site survey and imperial visits; village-by-village land purchases and compensation, 1884-88; the 1889 chinjufu ordinance and commander's arrival; the 1902 incorporation as a city and its population growth.
2. 呉市と海軍 [Kure City and the Navy], 呉市 (City of Kure), 1935; NDL frames 6, 15. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/1029205/1/6> (open online (NDL Digital Collections, no login)). Used for: Kure's 1935 population and status as one of Japan's ten largest cities; the Naval Arsenal's workforce boom, bust and revival; a second, independent date (1890) for the chinjufu's formal opening.
3. 大和ミュージアム (呉市海事歴史科学館) [Yamato Museum (Kure City Maritime History Science Museum)], 大和ミュージアム (Yamato Museum). <https://yamato-museum.com/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The museum's opening date and visitor milestones; the battleship Yamato's completion date, dimensions, displacement and sinking date.
4. 呉市 (公式ウェブサイト) [City of Kure (official website)], 呉市 (City of Kure). <https://www.city.kure.lg.jp/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Confirmation of the city's official web presence and its own 'Japan Heritage City' framing.
5. 日本遺産 鎮守府 横須賀・呉・佐世保・舞鶴 [Japan Heritage: the naval district cities of Yokosuka, Kure, Sasebo and Maizuru], 呉市観光振興課 / くれ観光情報サイト (Kure tourism site). <https://kure-trip.jp/features/24>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The Japan Heritage designation's theme and the specific heritage sites it lists in Kure.
6. 入船山記念館 [Irifuneyama Memorial Hall], 入船山記念館 (Irifuneyama Memorial Hall). <https://irifuneyama.com/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Identification of the building as the former Kure Naval District commander-in-chief's residence, its current use, and the former Arsenal clock tower on its grounds.
7. レファレンス協同データベース：戦時中に、呉市への空襲があった日時と場所について記載されている資料を探している [Collaborative Reference Database answer on the dates and locations of WWII air raids on Kure], 広島県立図書館 ほか, via NDL (Hiroshima Prefectural Library and others). https://crd.ndl.go.jp/reference/detail?page=ref_view&id=1000380377, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Air-raid dates on Kure in 1945 (4 May, 21 June, 1 July, 24 July) and the attack on the cruiser Tone, citing 呉市史 and 呉空襲記.
8. レファレンス協同データベース：太平洋戦争末期、瀬戸内海で米軍が機雷を投下した場所を知りたい [Collaborative Reference Database answer on US naval mine-laying in the Seto Inland Sea], via NDL. https://crd.ndl.go.jp/reference/detail?page=ref_view&id=1000363105, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The 30 March 1945 B-29 mine-laying operation in the waters around Kure and Hiroshima, citing 呉・戦災と復興.
9. レファレンス協同データベース：東広島市内の占領軍の進駐・駐留について [Collaborative Reference Database answer on occupation forces stationed around Higashi-Hiroshima], via NDL. https://crd.ndl.go.jp/reference/detail?page=ref_view&id=1000217942, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Kure as the headquarters of the British-Australian force occupying Hiroshima, Shimane and Yamaguchi prefectures, and Australian troops stationed at Kure from September 1946, citing 広島県警察百年史.
10. レファレンス協同データベース：江田島にあった占領軍キャンプで働いていた日本人に関する資料はあるか [Collaborative Reference Database answer on Japanese laborers at the occupation camp on Etajima], 広島県立図書館, via NDL (Hiroshima Prefectural Library). https://crd.ndl.go.jp/reference/detail?page=ref_view&id=1000363196, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: BCOF's use of the former Naval Academy on Etajima and its thousands of Japanese laborers, citing a dated 1947 photograph in 呉市史 第8巻.
11. 宮原の枕崎台風・昭和42年7月豪雨犠牲者慰霊碑 [Memorial to the Miyahara victims of the 1945 Makurazaki Typhoon and the heavy rain of July 1967], 国土地理院 自然災害伝承碑 (Geospatial Information Authority of Japan, Natural Disaster Legacy Monuments register); monument id 34202-002. <https://maps.gsi.go.jp/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: Citywide and Miyahara-specific death tolls for the 1945 typhoon and the 1967 flood.
12. 令和元年7月豪雨災害の記録：吉浦1 [Record of the July 2018 heavy-rain disaster: Yoshiura 1], 国土地理院 自然災害伝承碑 (Geospatial Information Authority of Japan, Natural Disaster Legacy Monuments register); monument id 34202-023. <https://maps.gsi.go.jp/>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The July 2018 debris-flow disaster in Yoshiura and its death toll.
13. *British Commonwealth Occupation Force 1945-52* [British Commonwealth Occupation Force 1945-52], Australian War Memorial. <https://www.awm.gov.au/articles/atwar/bcof>, checked 2026-09-28. Used for: The main body of Australian troops' arrival at Kure on 21 February 1946; BCOF's total strength (about 45,000, including roughly 16,000 Australians, with British, Indian and New Zealand troops); and the full list of prefectures and Shikoku it administered.

Further reading

- ・ 呉市史 第7巻・第8巻 (呉市史編纂委員会編, 1993, 1995) — The city's own official history; volumes 7-8 cover the war and occupation in detail, including the BCOF chapters cited via CRD in this dossier. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/9576719> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- ・ 呉の歩み2 (英連邦軍の見た呉) (呉市史編纂室編, 1996) — A volume specifically on Kure as seen by the British Commonwealth occupation forces. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13213829> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))
- ・ 呉・戦災と復興：旧軍港市転換法から平和産業港湾都市へ (呉市史編さん室編, 1997) — The city's own account of wartime destruction and the legal conversion of the naval port to civilian industrial use after 1945; NDL premises only. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/14022754> (NDL premises only)

- 英連邦軍の日本進駐と展開 (千田武志著, 1997) — A scholarly study of the British Commonwealth occupation force's deployment in Japan; NDL premises only. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/13850650> (NDL premises only)
- 呉市史 第3巻 (呉市史編纂室編, 1964) — Covers the founding period of the naval port and city in more institutional detail than the 1943 source used directly here. <https://dl.ndl.go.jp/pid/3008426> (NDL individual digital transmission (registered users))

Where a Deep Research request would go next

- **Household-level records of the 1884–88 land purchases from Miyahara, Washo and Shoyamada villages, including named families and disputes over compensation** — Kure City Archives (呉市総務部総務課 historical records section) and Hiroshima Prefectural Archives. Request the original 鎮守府用地買収関係 files; the 1943 source used here draws on such records but does not name individual households.
- **British and Australian-side records of BCOF's headquarters functions at Kure and its facilities on Etajima** — National Archives of Australia, the Australian War Memorial, and the UK National Archives (Kew). Search by unit war diaries for BCOF headquarters and its Kure/Etajima area commands; this session reached the Australian War Memorial's own summary page directly (see source S13) but not these two archives' own finding aids, and could not confirm the force's full command structure beyond its four contributing countries.
- **Full casualty and building-loss records for the four 1945 air raids on Kure and the mine-laying campaign** — Kure City Archives and the Hiroshima Prefectural Library's local history room. Consult 呉市史 第6巻 (pp.121-141) and 呉空襲記 (1979), both identified via the Collaborative Reference Database but not directly read for this dossier.
- **Construction and design records for the Irifuneyama commander-in-chief's residence and its 1990s conservation** — Agency for Cultural Affairs and the Hiroshima Prefecture cultural properties office. Request 広島県重要文化財旧呉鎮守府司令長官官舎修理工事報告書 (1996), identified in this dossier's research but not directly read (NDL premises only).
- **The exact year and process of Kure's Japan Heritage (日本遺産) designation alongside Yokosuka, Sasebo and Maizuru** — Agency for Cultural Affairs (文化庁) Japan Heritage program records. Search the agency's own Japan Heritage portal by story title; this dossier could not confirm the designation year from the pages read this session.

Caveats

- Two sources used here (from 1935 and 1943) both date the Kure chinjufu's formal opening ceremony to 1890, a year after the naval ordinance that created it (28 May 1889) and the arrival of its first commander (22 June 1889); this dossier reports both dates rather than resolving the apparent gap on its own authority.
- This dossier's BCOF facts are checked against the Australian War Memorial's own account, reached directly in this session, for the force's arrival date, total strength and the prefectures it administered. Japanese library and archive sources (via the Collaborative Reference Database) supply the remaining detail used here: Commonwealth troops' use of an inland training ground from September 1946, and Japanese laborers' work for the force at Etajima. The Department of Veterans' Affairs' Anzac Portal returned a server error and could not be checked; BCOF's full command structure beyond its four contributing countries is not stated here because it could not be verified.
- The exact construction date of the Irifuneyama commander-in-chief's residence, and the exact year of Kure's Japan Heritage designation, could not be confirmed from the official pages read this session and are therefore not stated.
- Casualty figures for the 1945 and 1967 disasters and the 2018 Yoshiura debris flow come from this project's own disaster-memorial dataset (drawn from the Geospatial Information Authority's Natural Disaster Legacy Monuments register) rather than from a source independently read in full this session.

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